

Get real Figma access in Claude Code

Right now the connector Capgemini gives you is read-only. Here is how to connect Figma's own MCP server directly, using your frog account, so Claude can actually build and edit, not just look.

QUICK FIX

Already connected but stuck read-only? Skip straight to Step 8. The fix is almost always the account, not the setup.

PART A — FIRST-TIME SETUP

figma app + terminal + vs code

- 1

Sign in to the Figma desktop app with your frog account

Not Capgemini SSO, not a personal login, the exact account with your Full/Edit seat. A View-only seat can't get write access no matter what you configure.
- 2

Turn on Figma's local MCP server

Figma menu (top-left icon) → Preferences → **Enable local MCP Server**. This starts a local bridge Claude Code can talk to.
- 3

In Terminal: connect the desktop server, scoped to you

Open a real terminal (not the VS Code panel is fine, just make sure it's interactive). The default scope is local, tied to one folder, so add `-s user` to make it yours everywhere.

```
claude mcp add --transport http figma-desktop http://127.0.0.1:3845/mcp -s user
```
- 4

Also connect the cloud server

This covers things the desktop bridge can't reach. Same rule, user scope.

```
claude mcp add --transport http figma https://mcp.figma.com/mcp -s user
```
- 5

Authorize the cloud server

It's OAuth-gated, and that login can only happen from an interactive terminal session, not from inside the VS Code extension.

```
claude
/mcp
```

Follow the Figma login prompt that appears.
- 6

Fully quit and reopen VS Code

Not "reload window," actually quit the app. The extension only reads your MCP server list on startup.
- 7

Start a brand-new Claude Code conversation

Not an old thread. Tool access locks in at the moment a session starts; reconnecting mid-chat won't add anything.

PART B — FIXING THE "CONNECTED BUT STILL READ-ONLY" PROBLEM

the account gotcha

- 8

Ask Claude to check who it's actually connected as

Have it call the Figma `whoami` tool. It returns the connected account's email; that's the real signal, not whatever the MCP panel says.
- 9

Wrong account? Switch it in Figma, not in Claude

If it's not your `@frogdesign.com` account, sign out in the Figma desktop app, sign back in as the right one, then reconnect the server from VS Code's Settings → gear icon → Local MCP Servers panel.
- 10

Restart again

After switching accounts, repeat Steps 6 through 7 above: full VS Code quit, then a new conversation. A mid-chat reconnect will not pick up the fixed account.
- 11

Still local-scoped from an old setup?

If a server was added without `-s user`, it's stuck to one folder and VS Code won't see it. Remove and redo it properly:

```
claude mcp remove <server-name>
```

then re-run the add command from Step 3 or 4 with `-s user` included.

Heads up. This connects straight to Figma using your own account, bypassing Capgemini's managed connector. That's what unlocks write access, but it also means it's outside IT's usual guardrails. If you're rolling this out beyond yourself, loop in your engagement's IT/security contact first rather than treating this as a standing policy.